

SANTOSH KUMAR PANT

Head Chef | Fermentation Production Specialist

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📍 Kuwait (Visa 18 — Transferable)

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Highly skilled Head Chef, Fermentation Production Specialist, and Food Safety professional with over 13 years of culinary and production experience across Kuwait and India. Specialist in artisan sourdough, lacto-fermented vegetables, kombucha, water kefir, and gluten-free vegan product development. Proven expertise in recipe costing, nutritional analysis, HACCP compliance, food safety management, HACCP implementation, allergen control, recipe costing, nutritional analysis, and kitchen team leadership. Experienced in conducting food safety audits, temperature monitoring, and maintaining full regulatory compliance. Adept at combining traditional fermentation science with modern food safety and health-food standards to deliver high-quality, commercially viable products.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Fermentation Production	Artisan Sourdough (GF & Vegan)	Recipe Costing & Cost Cards
Nutritional Analysis	HACCP & Food Safety	Inventory & Yield Management
Menu Planning & Development	Supplier Negotiation	Kitchen Team Leadership
Lacto-Fermented Vegetables	Kombucha & Water Kefir	Allergen & Label Compliance
Food Safety Auditing	Temperature & pH Control	Food Safety Officer Skills

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Head Chef & Fermentation Production Specialist

Bluezone Organic — Gluten-Free, Vegan Concept | Kuwait | Dec 2021 – Present

- Managed end-to-end fermentation production: artisan sourdough, lacto-fermented pickles, kimchi, sauerkraut, and cultured spreads
- Developed and standardized gluten-free and vegan recipes ensuring consistent quality, texture, and nutritional value
- Monitored fermentation cycles; controlled temperature, pH levels, and culture health across batch production
- Conducted detailed recipe costing — cost per ingredient, cost per portion, and food cost percentage (target: 28–35%)
- Built and maintained recipe cost cards factoring ingredient price fluctuations, wastage %, and batch yield

- Tracked weekly variance between budgeted and actual food costs; identified root causes and implemented corrective measures
- Performed per-serving nutritional analysis (calories, protein, carbohydrates, fat, dietary fibre) for all products
- Ensured accurate allergen and nutritional labelling in compliance with food safety regulations
- Collaborated with nutritionists to validate calorie counts and macro-nutrient profiles
- Negotiated with organic suppliers to maintain cost efficiency while upholding allergen-free sourcing standards
- Maintained raw material inventory; tracked production yield vs. input usage to minimise wastage
- Implemented and monitored HACCP plan across all production stages — biological, chemical, and physical hazard control
- Conducted daily temperature checks and maintained records for all refrigeration, cooking, and fermentation units
- Performed regular internal food safety audits — equipment sanitation, personal hygiene, storage conditions, and labelling
- Ensured all products met Kuwait MOH and international food safety regulations before release
- Trained kitchen team on food safety procedures, allergen handling, cross-contamination prevention, and HACCP protocols

Head Chef

The Dining Doctor | Kuwait | Jul 2018 – Nov 2021

- Oversaw full kitchen operations, menu planning, and team supervision for a health-focused restaurant
- Designed calorie-controlled and allergen-free menus aligned with customer dietary requirements
- Trained and coordinated kitchen staff to maintain quality and hygiene standards

Assistant Chef

BABEL — Lebanese Concept, M.H. Alshaya Co. | Kuwait | Jun 2016 – Jul 2018

- Assisted in preparation and execution of Lebanese cuisine in a high-volume, multinational restaurant chain
- Ensured consistent quality, portion control, and adherence to standard recipes
- Coordinated with senior chefs on menu updates, food cost controls, and supplier procurement

Chef de Partie

Pasta Mania — Italian Concept | Kuwait | Mar 2013 – May 2016

- Managed a specific kitchen section, ensuring smooth preparation and timely service of Italian dishes
- Maintained mise en place, monitored portion sizes, and minimised wastage to control food cost

Earlier Positions

Commis Chef I — Philip Bistro, New Delhi | **Commis Chef II** — Visionnaire Café, NCR Delhi | **Commis Chef** — Sun & Sand, Nagpur

EDUCATION & QUALIFICATIONS

M.Sc. in Hotel & food science.

Amazon Institute of Hotel and Tourism Management, Dehradun | 2008 – 2011

Punjab Technical University, Jalandhar

Graduation

Kumaun University, Nainital

Intermediate & Matriculation

Uttarakhand Examination Board | Uttar Pradesh Examination Board

PERSONAL DETAILS

Date of Birth: 05 March 1985

Father's Name: Subhash Chandra Pant

Nationality: Indian

Marital Status: Married

Gender: Male

Languages Known: English, Hindi, Arabic

Current Location: Kuwait

Permanent Address: Pithoragarh, Uttarakhand, India

Visa Status: Visa 18 — Transferable

I hereby declare that all information provided above is true and correct to the best of my knowledge.